Technical report — Gegenprobe: one schema and a converter for Swiss parliamentary answers

Track 2A — OpenParlData · Online · Team 444 — Roman (+ Claude Code agents, §7) · Evidence site https://gegenprobe.mi11ion.io · **Maturity:** census and Bern repair lists = *ready for OPD to apply* (needs its choice on the document hash); source-adapter lists = *audited prototype*; nightly job = *deployable prototype* (one real night on a CI runner; not yet at OPD); rules-only converter = *tested prototype*; review mode, whole and virtual affairs = *feasibility study*; schema v0.1 = *draft*.

1. Summary

Verdict. A common schema is feasible with date roles and typed nulls; the converter fills what documents print: the answer date in depth, 7 fields on whole affairs, per-question Q/A pairs, people, recommendation and reasoning (P5); only the type runs unattended (the *unattended bar*: a 95% lower bound ≥ 0.80). Of 17 fields, 12 are shared (meaning tested for 1, the other 11 by definition), 5 shared with a role split, all measured ("answer date" is decided, dispatched or registered), 3 concepts body-specific; **4 fields are feasible from metadata, 13 partial, 0 need a different concept** (§5). Every value carries its source (page and character span, or the OPD record; an Apertus value is printed text by construction); categorical suggestions are document-level; a missing value is a typed null that says why. By default frozen DE/FR/IT rules run without a model and no outside service beyond OPD's exports and the parliaments' own sites; review mode adds one model endpoint the operator sets.
The cross-parliamentary result. OpenParlData (OPD) publishes the affairs of 89 Swiss parliaments with affairs in scope (it scrapes 90). Of 91,268 interventions whose events record a written government answer, **16,749 (18.4%) have no answer text in OPD**; 1,422 were answered orally (1,016 Valais oral-answer stubs, 406 question-time answers), so **15,327 written answers are missing: 17.1% of the 89,846 answered in writing** (2024–25: 1,488 of 12,632, 11.8%), each typed by cause. Bern 2024–25: 567 of 593 written answers lack text, most in OPD but unlinked; Neuchâtel 2024–25: 161 of 162 are not in OPD. OPD confirmed the Bern linking bug and that our relink list is the workaround until its fix ships (correspondence, 10 Oct 2026; a published excerpt awaits OPD's consent). **Deterministic routes now propose repairs for 9,940 of the 16,749** (was 3,107): source adapters for 50 parliaments verify 6,833 more; a blind audit of 300 random ones finds 297 answers, 0 wrong, 3 unclear (precision 0.990, Wilson 0.971–0.997); 4,818 written answers still need adapters (was 10,800). **Where Apertus earns its place** (§6). Not by beating the same model asked freely (P2 53 vs 54 of 62, re-parsed; P6 59 vs 62 of 68, registered), but by finding what rules miss and abstaining where nothing is printed: on 15 parliaments no rule was written for it finds 24/29 answer dates, the rules 2/29 (ahead in 6 parliaments, behind in none, p = 0.031), and dates 4 of 33 answerless documents where the latest printed date dates 31; on 8 more (P6) rules, then Apertus find 31/34, rules alone 20/34 (11:0, p = 0.001); it fills whole-affair answer dates (22/27 → 27/27; 20/35 → 31/35) and doubles submitter extraction (P5: 12/40 → 24/40). A model from another vendor relabelled the gold blind: no registered decision changes in P1, P2, P6; in P5 too noisy to judge.

2. Architecture

1. **Census** (`census/`): streams the OPD exports once into a per-affair *answer-link status* (`attached | agenda | parentless | absent | image_only | oral`), the feasibility matrix and a comparability measure.
2. **Repair** (`repair/`): deterministic routes per cause, triple-checked (affair number or title, answer heading, date against OPD's answer event), as lists keyed on OPD ids: Bern relinks and fetches, source adapters for 50 parliaments (`repair/adapters/`); a nightly job (`deploy/nightly/`) re-runs them.
3. **Converter** (`convert/`, `qa/`): (i) OPD metadata and events, (ii) frozen DE/FR/IT anchor rules, (iii) the Apertus closed-set pointer on the residue. Modes: `rules_only` (default, no model) and `review` (suggestions with page, span and margin, flagged `needs_review`).
4. **Schema and validator** (`schema/`, `validate/`): Pydantic schema v0.1, normative; every field is a value with provenance {`value, role, page, char_start, char_end, quote, route, rule, model_build, θ, margin`} or a *typed null* (`not_in_document | unlinked | image_only | oral | text_failed | present_unanchored | no_rules_for_body | not_applicable`); `QAItem` pairs question *n* with its answer passage, filled by `qa/` (P5); validation uses the Pydantic models.

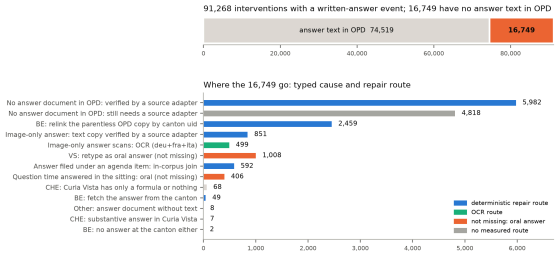


Figure 1. National answer funnel with typed causes and repair routes.

3. Use of Apertus

Closed-set pointer (`convert/pointer.py`, prompts `src/prompts/{de,fr,it}`). The document (first 12,000 characters) and the question go in the user message, the assistant turn is prefilled with a JSON prefix, and `null` and every distinct date printed in the document are scored as continuations by summed log-probability (`prompt_logprobs`). Null if `lp(null) − logsumexp(lp(dates)) > θ`, else the best date, mapped back to its span. θ does not transfer across builds (spike F2: a θ fitted on RLVR scores 0.25 on the final build), so it is fitted per build on dev documents and frozen: θ = 10.40 for the Public AI build (AUROC 0.99, leave-one-out 124/127 [93.3, 99.2]). The same form picks labels, OPD affair numbers and, in `qa/`, the question a paragraph answers, the recommendation sentence or the submitter's printed name. **Why a pointer** (spikes, `results/report/cited_spikes.json`): asked freely, Apertus dates 15/15 (8B) and 14/15 (70B) Bern interventions that have no answer; a null-allowed prompt fixes the 70B (0/15), not the 8B (14/15). A reader v2 (answer-present gate, then the gold guide's decision-before-letter-date rule) did not beat that prompt in P6 (§6).

Which Apertus, which size. Unless marked 8B, Apertus numbers are the **70B** weights, which Public AI serves as `swiss-ai/apertus-v1.5-8b`; inferred, not documented: the served fingerprint (`tp8-pp2-…`, tensor-parallel 8 × pipeline-parallel 2) and the behaviour point to the 70B (cited: 760/792 greedy outputs byte-identical to the 70B name; MMLU 84.4% vs 70.8% for the v1 8B route). The response `model` is checked on every call (the `-70b` name answers prefills with Qwen-SEA-LION, 3/3), and every cached P1/P2 answer comes from one served build (`results/eval/served_models.json`, D10). The **8B** is `swiss-ai/Apertus-v1.5-8B` as a community text-only export quantised to 4 bits by a community member (`Colby/apertus-v1.5-8b-text-Q4_K_M-GGUF`, sha256-pinned; not an official Swiss AI release; `docs/runbook.md` "Supply chain"), run with llama.cpp on one 4-vCPU machine, own θ = 16.73 (exploratory arms, D2/D3). On P1 it is less accurate than the 70B (pointer and cascade McNemar p = 0.0051 and 3.6×10^{-5}) and dates 25 of 90 answerless documents (70B: 7); its residue suggestions are right 7/34 (70B 9/16). On the 52 P2 documents reachable from CI (D2-6) it is behind the 70B (2 vs 10 documents, p = 0.039); it finds 15 of 21 answer dates (70B 16, rules 2, the ungated latest printed date 14) but dates 11 of 31 answerless documents (70B 4). Its fast scorer failed both registered parity gates and passed a replacement gate written before any 8B arm ran (D9). The 8B on P6 is running on CI. **Recommendation:** `rules_only` unattended; for review suggestions the 8B as the measured sovereign option (a reviewer rejects more), the 70B for accuracy on infrastructure the operator chooses. Review mode refuses a served build θ was not fitted on: the first response from another fingerprint stops the run (exit 3) before any suggestion is attached (`docs/runbook.md` "Review mode in operation").

Cost (`results/report/cost_end_to_end.json`, one core, no GPU). Fetch, extraction and checks: about 2.1 s per document, plus 6.9 s per OCR page; the rules process 480 documents per second (0.5 CPU-hours for all 902,754 documents in OPD's export). Review mode adds the pointer on the residue (97 of 154 held-out documents): 3.5 calls and 5,905 billed prompt tokens per residue document on the 70B, USD 0.59 per 1,000 residue documents at Public AI's list price; the 8B takes 180 s per document on 4 vCPUs, 50 machine-hours per 1,000. At ten times OPD's volume: about 5 CPU-hours for the rules, about USD 3,357 for review mode on the 70B.

4. Data and operations

OPD bulk exports (snapshot 6 Oct 2026; OPD's API robots.txt disallows `/v1/`), Bern open data, Fedlex, parliament sites and APIs, fetched politely (≥ 1.2 s per host; robots.txt per RFC 9309, incident in §5). `make run` and the nightly unit run the image read-only, as a non-root uid, with `--cap-drop ALL` and `no-new-privileges`; PDFs are capped at 50 MB, each pdftotext/tesseract call at 300 s, each document at 600 s, every hit a typed failure row; failed alerts are re-sent the next night. **One real night** (`results/monitor/night_real_38062530586/`): under systemd on a GitHub-hosted 4-vCPU runner against OPD's live exports, 83 min (32 of them reading the exports: 6.2 GB streamed, 198 MB of single exports stored; about 50 the first night's triple check of all 2,508 Bern rows), 28 min of CPU, 2,078 MB peak; it reproduced the Bern list on live data (2,459 relink, 49 fetch) and raised no alert (a first night has no previous state for drop and

trend alerts). A two-night Docker run is scheduled. Inside OPD (`GP_EXPORTS_DIR`) a night with no changed files took 96.8 s.

5. Results without a model: schema verdict, census, repair

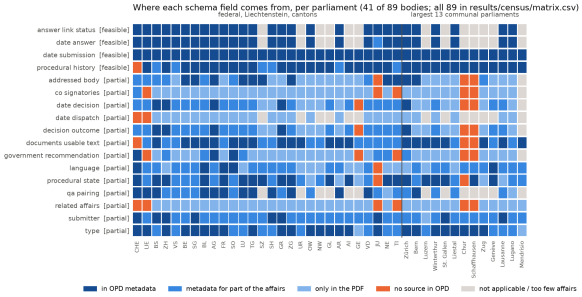


Figure 2. Where each schema field comes from, per parliament (all 89 in `results/census/matrix.csv`). Orange = not in OPD's data for that parliament (the parliament may still publish it), not a different concept.

One verdict per field, on two axes. *Where the value lives*: *feasible* if OPD metadata carries it in ≥ 80% of eligible parliaments, *fundamentally different* if ≥ 20% have no written source, else *partial* (`docs/census.md` §3); no field is orange in a fifth of the parliaments, at a 10% threshold 5 fields would be (`results/census/tier_sensitivity.json`). *What it means*, from OPD's own vocabularies (`results/census/comparability.json`): the classes below, the finding for the eCH group (`docs/ech-onepager.md`). Type is harmonised for 82.9% of affairs, procedural state for only 278; the government recommendation is in metadata for 34.2% of motions and postulates and PDF-only in 56 bodies.

meaning	feasible from metadata	partial	meaning tested? (evidence)
shared (12)	submission date, link status	submitter, co-signatories, addressed body, recommendation, decision and dispatch dates, Q/A pairing, related affairs, language, usable text	1 of 12: the recommendation (0 of 183 labels ambiguous); the other 11 by definition, untested
shared with a role split (5)	**answer date**, procedural history	type, procedural state, decision outcome	all 5 measured: in 7 of 54 bodies the "answer" event is mostly the submission date; OPD's event equals the printed date for 37 held-out documents and differs for 7; 35 event labels carry different date roles; 42 of 1,038 type labels map to different harmonised types ("Antrag" alone to 7); 32 state, 3 outcome labels ambiguous
body-specific (3)	—	—	oral answers (23.6% of question time is oral); executive-own business; minutes-only councils (16 bodies publish only meeting documents, 8 without any affair → `virtual` affairs, P4)

29.1% of events have no harmonised id. Where OPD metadata carries a field it mostly agrees with print (P3: type 17/18, submitter 23/28, submission date 15/21; affair numbers 21/29, format differences). **Cross-parliamentary question:** across 54 parliaments, 82.3% of written answers have their text in OPD (85.0% after the measured repairs). Answer times are not one quantity: pooled over 90,556 dated answers the median is 68 days, mixing what OPD's "answer" date is: 112 days where it is the verified decision date (Bern, Ticino: 2,379 of 2,379 answers whose title names the date), 79 on a government's weekly sitting, 62 for mixed and 39 for diffuse, publication-like dates; in 7 parliaments the "answer" is the submission date.

Repair. Bern: of 3,532 answers the canton publishes, OPD attaches 229 (6.5%), although 96.1% are in OPD and linkable: 527 under an agenda item, 2,638 parentless with the canton's document uid; 179 parentless answers are not missing (155 affairs already have the text, 24 have no answer event). Against OPD's own copy, all 2,459 relink candidates match affair number and heading; the decision date equals OPD's event for 2,332 with the registered parser and 2,421 [97.9, 98.9] with a later parser (pre-registered sample: 36/40, three parser misses and one canton typo). **Counts per file:** 2,459 relink candidates = 2,421 in `repair_BE_relink.tsv` + 38 in review; 49 fetch candidates = 48 in `repair_BE_fetch.tsv` + 1 in review (`repair_BE_review.tsv`, 39 rows); **Note for OPD:** the document `hash` is sha256(body_key + parent_type + url) (49,810 of 49,810 rows of the 10 Oct export), and the 2,421 relink documents are stored as `parent_type = agenda`, so relinking changes their identifier and file URL unless OPD keeps the old one. A second list corrects 727 Bern `begin_date` load timestamps (557 on 2024-10-28 + 170 from later loads, the groups OPD described; 554 from the affair's own submission event). Federal placeholders (57.3% of federal documents): Fedlex recovers 40/50 [67, 88.8]. Scans: DE+FR+IT OCR gave usable text for 15/15 [79.6, 100] image-only answers in a probe (a coarse check); re-taking a published text version (Ticino: `r100.19.doc`) is cheaper. **Source adapters** (`repair/adapters/`, `docs/adapters.md`). Adapters for 50 parliaments (10 with routes of their own, e.g. Zürich canton and St. Gallen) verify 6,833 answers (5,982 of the 10,800 absent, 851 of the 1,350 image-only) by affair number or title, the parliament's answer formula and a

date check: an exact match to an OPD event (6,437) or within a per-parliament window (396; at most 15 days in Zürich city, 120 in Valais). Listed, not counted: 282 Jura answers that match by identity and wording only (OPD's Jura answer events carry no date) and 697 rows for a person. Deterministic routes now propose repairs for **9,940 of the 16,749**; **4,818** written answers still need adapters (was 10,800 with no answer document anywhere in OPD). 2,316 of the "missing" answers are in OPD with text, filed under the question's file and worded outside our frozen census lexicon (Zürich city alone 1,417): the repair is a category on the document (`tag_answer`). *Audits* (blind Claude agents): a design audit of 796 rows found 34 non-answers among 511 verified rows (deadline extensions, commission reports, minutes that refer to the answer); typed filters now catch all 34 and remove none of the sample's 713 answers. A fresh random sample of 300 counted rows, drawn after the filters were frozen: 297/300 are the executive's answer, 0 wrong, 3 unclear, **precision 0.990** (Wilson 0.971–0.997). *Incident* (`docs/incidents.md`): our network layer checked robots.txt with Python's first-match parser, where RFC 9309 requires the longest match; on 10 Oct this let 3 Ticino answer files on a disallowed path through once. They were deleted and are used nowhere; since 11 Oct one RFC 9309 matcher is installed into every Gegenprobe process (`src/sitecustomize.py`; the locked `net.py` unchanged), and an audit of the 7,463 documents the adapters fetched found no other disallowed path among the 7,393 re-checkable ones.

6. Evaluation: seven pre-registrations

Design. Seven tests: **P1**, 154 held-out documents from parliaments the rules were written for; **P2**, 62 documents from 15 parliaments no rule was written for; **P3**, 29 whole affairs; **P3b**, its pre-registered replication on 36 fresh affairs; **P4**, affairs rebuilt from minutes; **P5**, Q/A pairs, people, recommendation and reasoning on 40 fresh affairs (registered in `eval/prereg6`); **P6**, an answer-date reader v2 on 68 fresh documents (`eval/prereg7`). Each froze code, prompts, θ and the scorer by sha256 before any label was committed: the LOCK commit precedes the labels by 6 min 0 s (P1), 2 min 28 s (P2), 3 min 37 s (P3), 4 min 3 s (P4) by commit date, an order GitHub's clock confirms (`results/eval/lock_server_times_all.json`); for P3b, P5 and P6 the LOCK precedes the draw. P1's frozen rules were committed with its sample (D12): P1 is held out by protocol, P2 is the clean out-of-sample test of the rules. Unit (P1, P2, P6): one document's answer date, strict. Arms on identical inputs: **rules**; **pointer** (Apertus on every document); **cascade** (rules, then the pointer on the residue = every review suggestion accepted); **naive** free generation, plain and null-allowed, same weights. **Gold, checked by another vendor.** No human labelled a gold value, by design: two blind Claude annotators (Opus, Sonnet), a third breaks ties, quotes verified by code, raw annotations committed. `Qwen-SEA-LION-v4-32B-IT` (AI Singapore, Qwen family; neither Anthropic nor Apertus) relabelled all 216 P1 and P2 documents blind from the same guide and text (post hoc, D14/D2-7; 216 calls, USD 0.14), and P5 and P6 as registered. Exact answer date: P1 134/154 (κ 0.80), P2 56/62 (κ 0.87). No registered decision changes when only the documents where both vendors agree are kept or Qwen's labels replace the gold: P2-H2 is 22 vs 0 under the gold, 21 vs 0 and 23 vs 1. It reads the same text, so it is no human audit. P1-H1 (null safety) rests on contested documents: 6 of the 7 values fall on documents OPD types as reports; without the 24 reports it is 1/72 (upper 7.5%), where both vendors agree 2/84, under Sonnet's labels 5/88. Non-LLM checks: OPD's event matches 37 of 44 checkable P1 dates (5 of the other 7 are 1–5 days apart: decision vs dispatch); Ticino titles 20/20; P3 answer dates 18/21; P2: 6 of 29 checkable exactly (6/6 agree), 19/29 face a non-LLM bound. **Statistics** (post hoc, D10): over the 9 registered confirmatory tests of P1–P4 and P3b all 4 held conclusions survive Holm (P2-H2 3.8×10^{-6}) and BH; the registered lenient metric changes no decision; document-level p-values ignore clustering by parliament, so per-parliament results stand beside them. Deviations: `eval/prereg*/DEVIATIONS*.md`; D8: the Opus tie-breaker sided with Opus in 36/41 P1 ties, 35 on the recommendation only.

P1 — 154 held-out documents from the parliaments the rules were written for (DE/FR/IT × canton/commune + Ticino scans; 64 with an answer date, 90 without; always-null 90/154; κ 0.95 presence, 0.94 date; 41 tie-breaks).

arm	exact [95% CI]	dates found	wrong printed date	fabricated	values on answerless
rules only (default mode)	**135/154 [81.5, 92]**	47	4	0	2
pointer	130/154 [77.9, 89.3]	46	16	0	6
cascade (suggestions accepted)	139/154 [84.6, 94]	56	11	0	7
8B pointer (CPU, exploratory)	112/154 [65.2, 79.1]	50	37	0	28
8B cascade (CPU, exploratory)	119/154 [70, 83.2]	54	31	0	25
naive, null-allowed	134/154 [80.8, 91.4]	47	11	0	3
↳ null-allowed, re-parsed (D5)	133/154 [80.1, 90.9]	47	13	0	4
naive, plain	98/154 [55.8, 70.8]	47	23	24	39
↳ plain, re-parsed (D5)	103/154 [59.1, 73.8]	54	26	24	41

8B rows: §3. 70B: **H1 null safety failed**: the cascade dates 7 of 90 answerless documents (upper bound 15.2% vs 10%). **H2 gave Branch B** (FR+IT+scans, n = 110: cascade alone right on 5, rules alone on 1, p = 0.22): Apertus adds no null safety (cascade 7/90 answerless dated, rules 2/90), so it left the unattended path (default `rules_only`) for an opt-in review suggestion (D6), which P2 then tested. **H3 passed**: AUROC 0.969 on all documents, 0.966 on the registered length-matched set. **H4 triggered**: 3 of 8 Apertus-decided FR/IT values are wrong. Post hoc: latest printed date on answer-typed documents 131/154 (vs pointer 11:12 documents, p = 1).

P2 — 62 documents from 15 parliaments absent from every dev and held-out set (29 with an answer date, from 7 of the 15: VD 8, NW 6, Bellinzona 5, OW 4, Vernier 3, SZ 2, Schlieren 1; 33 without; always-null 33/62; two Claude annotators κ 1.0 on dates, the other vendor 56/62, κ 0.87). Wilson 95% CIs; italic rows post hoc (`results/eval2/posthoc_r5_p2_table.json`).

arm	exact [CI]	dates found [CI]	wrong date	invented	answerless dated [CI]
rules only	35/62 [44.1, 68.1]	**2/29** [1.9, 22]	2	0	0 [0, 10.4]
pointer	**53/62** [74.7, 92.2]	**24/29** [65.5, 92.4]	8	0	4 [4.8, 27.3]
cascade	51/62 [71, 89.8]	22/29 [57.9, 87.8]	10	0	4 [4.8, 27.3]
naive, null-allowed	52/62	22/29	7	1	3
↳ null-allowed, re-parsed (D2-4)	54/62	24/29	7	1	3
naive, plain	45/62	21/29	8	4	9
↳ plain, re-parsed (D2-4)	49/62	25/29	9	4	9
latest printed date	*24/62* [27.6, 51.2]	*22/29* [57.9, 87.8]	*38*	*0*	*31* [80.4, 98.3]
latest, answer-typed	*44/62* [58.7, 80.8]	*18/29* [44, 77.3]	*13*	*0*	*7* [10.7, 37.8]

P2-H1: rules' recall 47/64 → 2/29. **Per parliament** (post hoc, D2-1, D2-6): the pointer is ahead in 6, the rules in 0, 1 tie on answered documents (sign test p = 0.031); 6 vs 2 with 7 ties on all 62 (p = 0.29). **P2-H2 holds** (document level): on the 29 answered documents 22 only the pointer vs 0 only the rules (McNemar $p = 4.8 \times 10^{-7}$; without Bellinzona 17 vs 0, $p = 1.5 \times 10^{-5}$); on all 62, 22 vs 4 ($p = 5.3 \times 10^{-4}$). **Baselines** (post hoc): the ungated latest printed date finds 22/29 (pointer vs it on answered documents 3 vs 1) but dates 31 of the 33 answerless documents; against the latest date gated by document type: 10 vs 1 documents (p = 0.012), 6 vs 0 parliaments (p = 0.031), chosen after the results. **P2-H3 failed**: the cascade dates 4/33 answerless documents (upper bound 27.3% vs 15%). **P2-H4 holds**: AUROC 0.983; θ = 0 (secondary) 54/62. *Error profile:* rules right 35, wrong printed date 2, answerless dated 0, missed 25; pointer 53, 4, 4, 1; cascade 51, 6, 4, 1: on 2 documents a rule (`rrb_vom`) fired with a wrong printed date, so Apertus was never asked.

P3 — whole affairs: 29 affairs (58 PDFs), 10 parliaments (5 with rules, 5 without), DE/FR/IT. A feasibility study (extractor, prompts and sample in one commit, D3-5). Arms: OPD metadata (M), rules (R), the default metadata + rules (C), C + Apertus on fields C leaves open (CA); annotators agreed on ≥ 27/29 affairs per field.

arm	type	number	submitter	submitted	answer date	addressed body*	decision no.†
M	17/29	21/29	23/29	15/21	21/27	0/28	0/17
R	26/29	14/29	5/29	4/21	16/27	4/28	5/17
C	**27/29**	**21/29**	**23/29**	**15/21**	**22/27**	**4/28**	**0/17**
CA	27/29	21/29	23/29	15/21	27/27	23/28	0/17

*Every gold value is "executive"; a constant scores 28/28 (D3-3). †Defect D3-1: the frozen cascade's metadata branch drops the rule's number; post hoc C = 5/17. No field reaches the unattended bar. H3 (Apertus on open fields: recall 25/32, precision 25/34) is dominated by the near-constant field, withdrawn; without it 6/8 and 6/9.

P3b, held-out replication (PREREG5; 36 fresh affairs, 9 parliaments, D5-1; κ ≥ 0.97 per field): *replicated* by its registered criteria (S1: Apertus's recall on the open fields has a lower bound ≥ 0.50; S2: each eligible field within or above P3's CI, at most one below). S2 is lenient: the field below is the answer date, the one the case for Apertus rests on. Apertus on open fields recall 14/16 [64, 96.5]; 4 of 5 eligible fields within or above P3's CIs; answer date C 20/35 (the unattended default wrote 4/35 wrong dates, P1: 4/154; in 3 Luzern affairs a frozen rule replaced OPD's correct date, 23/35 had it been kept, D5-2; with Apertus 31/35, its 11 suggestions 11/11 right); precision 14/20 keeps the reviewer gate; type 35/36 reaches the unattended bar. A product-path guard now keeps OPD's date when a rule-read date equals the submission date and flags the record (post hoc: fires on 3 of 36 P3b affairs, all Luzern, all kept dates right; none of 29 in P3).

P4 — virtual affairs: 6 held-out sittings of Bulle's council, 120 agenda items. Rules derive 99 items (precision 99/99, titles 99/99), type 91/99 (H2), the decision for 49/63 (46/63 correct), invent none of 36, date all 6 sittings (H4). **H1 failed** (recall 99/120, 82.5%; sub-items, unnumbered lines); **H3 failed** (Apertus +2 decisions, p = 0.5). Transfer cell (2 sittings of La Chaux-de-Fonds, D4-4): items 9/9, titles 9/9, decisions 0/9 by rules, 2/9 found with Apertus (1 correct): decision parsing is commune-specific.

P5 — Q/A pairs, people, recommendation, reasoning: 40 fresh affairs from 10 parliaments the converter was not developed on (DE/FR/IT; annotators agreed on question count, answer style and recommendation in 40/40). `qa/` fills `QAItem` with spans; rules decide first, Apertus only points over printed candidates. **H1:** rules-only pairing is *partial*: precision 0.83 (Wilson 0.75–0.88; 118/143), recall 0.67 (0.60–0.74; 118/176), short of the unattended bar. **H2:** rules beat paragraph order, 116:5 discordant answers ($p = 7.8 \times 10^{-29}$). **H4:** the closed-set system beats free generation, 79:11 ($p = 3.9 \times 10^{-14}$); free generation pairs 50/176, and 87 of its quoted values are in no document. **H5:** zero provenance failures (517 rule values). **H3:** the dev-fitted pairing pointer abstained on all 36 residue answers. **Verdict: supported, at the partial tier.** Questions 167/187, reasoning 37/40, recommendation 34/40 (36/40 with the pointer). Submitter rules overfit the dev layouts (36/38 → 12/40); the pointer over printed names doubles them to 24/40, free generation finds the submitter best (34/40), so it stays a review field. Post hoc: pairing transfers where answers number or repeat the questions (Riehen 21/22, Wädenswil 20/24, Lugano 17/20), fails where they do not (Valais 0/11). Qwen's labels pass the verbatim quote check in only 7/40 files and match the gold's answer spans in 96/176; as gold they would drop H1 to *not yet* (65/116, 65/105): too noisy to confirm or to overturn the verdict.

P6 — answer-date reader v2: 68 fresh documents from 8 parliaments in no earlier set (55 DE, 13 FR, no Italian; 34 with an answer date, 34 without; annotators disagreed on 1). v2: an answer-present gate, then guided generation kept only if printed, else a choice by date role.

arm (strict)	exact	dates found	answerless dated	printed nowhere
free prompt, null allowed	**62/68**	32/34	4/34	0
free prompt with v2's instructions	61/68	32/34	5/34	0
rules, then v2 on the residue (cascade v2)	60/68	**31/34**	5/34	0
v2	59/68	30/34	5/34	0
v1 pointer (θ = 10.40)	56/68	29/34	7/34	0
rules only	54/68	20/34	0/34	0
free prompt, plain	54/68	33/34	13/34	5
latest printed date	*29/68*	*27/34*	*32/34*	*0*

No registered hypothesis holds. H1, v2 vs free prompting: 1:4 discordant ($p = 0.38$). H2: v2 dates 5/34 answerless documents (upper bound 30.1% > 15%). H3, v2 vs v1: 5:2 ($p = 0.45$). Registered consequence: no claim that the pointer form beats free prompting on accuracy; v1 stays in the review mode. Secondary: cascade v2 vs rules on answered documents 11:0 ($p = 0.001$). Qwen: presence κ 0.91, date κ 0.86; no decision changes under its labels (v2 60/68, free prompt 61/68). Post hoc: 4 of v2's 9 errors are Interlaken answers its presence gate stopped (AUROC 0.93), 4 Lyss documents the gold calls answerless.

What the tests say. Apertus earns its place where layout varies and no rule exists: it finds what rules miss (P2: 22:4 documents against the rules; P6: rules → Apertus 11:0; whole-affair answer dates in P3/P3b), doubles submitter extraction (P5), and abstains where nothing is printed (P2). On P1 the rules alone match rules + Apertus (Branch B), so the default runs no model; in P4 Apertus added no significant decisions; the rules are incomplete too (P1 recall 47/64, P4 99/120). **Accuracy is not the pointer's argument:** asked freely with a null-allowed prompt, the same Apertus is as accurate (P2 re-parsed 54/62 vs 53/62, discordant 1 vs 0, $p = 1$; P6 62 vs 59). The closed-set form guarantees a printed value with page and span (32/32 on P2; no pointer arm returned an unprinted date, the plain prompt invented 24 in P1 and 5 in P6), and its margin orders the review queue (strong band 26/33 right, weak 3/11, post hoc); the free prompt quotes its date verbatim for 17/32 values. Writing the gold guide's decision-before-letter-date rule into the prompt lifted every Apertus arm on P1 dev (in-sample; free prompt 116/127 → 125/127).

7. Limitations, reproducibility, declarations

Limits: answer dates are tested in depth, Q/A pairs on 40 affairs (P5); tables, annexes and images are not extracted; P3/P3b are small (29 + 36 affairs), P4 one commune, P6 has no Italian document; no gold set contains federal documents; the 8B was not run on P3/P3b/P5; spans index our own pdftotext/tesseract text. `make run` (Docker, CPU, clean checkout) recomputes the census, the Bern join and triple check, sample conversions with validator checks, the scores, hypotheses and LOCK files of P1–P4 and P3b and the 8B analysis, re-derives the P1 rules arm from the source PDFs and P1/P2 Apertus decisions from the model cache (locally rules 154/154, Apertus 154/154 (P1) and 62/62 (P2) identical; CI run 38062904003, `results/ci/`: 129/129 and 49/49 reachable decisions, 788 claims), and re-checks every number in `claims.tsv`, P5 and P6 included. Claude Code agents (Anthropic) wrote most code, documentation and the gold labels; numbers are checked by code. Public AI (may route outside Switzerland) served evaluation only. Next: the Bern and adapter lists and the nightly job at OPD; adapters for the 4,818 answers still found only at the source; schema v0.2 (date roles, `QAItem`, five gaps) with the eCH group; per-commune decision parsing (P4). Report CC-BY-4.0; standards in `docs/mapping.md`.